410

# "What mods should I get?" A non exhaustive list of worthwhile Starsector Mods for experienced players and new alike to consider! Mods (self.starsector)

submitted 10 months ago * by Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic

Greetings Starfarer, Walker, or Captains alike, I'm a firm believer of putting my money where my mouth is so I figured I'd be the change I want to see to this discussion! I'm also a believer the best way to explore modding this game is vibes based, so I'm not here to tell you which mods are the best, because such a thing doesn't really exist in my opinion. Instead, I'll give the elevator pitch for many notable mods and why they are worth considering, so you can pick and choose your Laundry List of ones that you like. For me I try to maintain a Vanilla - Vanilla+ power level on my mods for ships/factions so I am biased towards those, but this doesn't mean mods outside of that (admittedly vague and easily debated) category are not still great and I'll try to note honorable mentions!

I'll divide mods into broad categories to make them more easily parsed and easy to find stuff you're looking for. I won't use the exact categories on the Mod Index, (located here https://fractalsoftworks.com/forum/index.php?topic=177.0 ) but they all should be accessible there. **For mods I haven't ever played directly I'll indicate as such with an Asterisk after**, and if someone who has experienced them has a better writeup to offer than what I'll give, I'll happily slot it in with a credit. If I did not include your favorite mod, you're welcome to comment it and if it seems like a good addition I'll try to slot it in with credit, this list is NOT EXHAUSTIVE and plenty of good mods will not be mentioned, so please do explore the index still! And show all the authors the respect they deserve for making our game even better to enjoy.

Note: not every mod listed will be updated to .98 at the time of writing, but any one I list either is so or I can confirm I've used by modifying the file without issue. Additionally categories will be fairly flexible because a lot of mods can touch a lot of systems a little bit but have one focus

**QOL Mods** (Straightforward, these can just be simple, helpful mods to make life a little nicer)

- SpeedUp - If ever there was a mod people actually consider "essential" it's this. It's very simple, you can speed the game up more with toggles if you want. No frills, great QOL, no notes!
- Leading Pip - Another very simple one. Lock on and you can visually see where you need to aim to hit roughly. It can lead you astray if the enemy is able to maneuver away, but it's nice for helping you judge things!
- Guarantee Rare Items* - I don't personally run this because other mods I enjoy find solutions to this possible issue but it's very simple. It ensures there's always at least 1 of every colony item spawned to salvage *somewhere* as it's hypothetically possible for none of what you want to spawn in the base game and this can be very unpleasant.
- Demand Indicators - Gives a visual way to tell just how much of an excess or shortage of an item there is in a shop. Very nice UI improvement, makes trading less of a hassle. No frills, simple and good!
- D-Mod Services - Simple mod for D mod enjoyers, lets you shoot your ships up at size 6 or above planets to make them D modded out. If you're willing to pay a mean chunk of change you can pick your D mods. It has some optional features too like being able to make ships unrestorable when you do this so you can mix Ops and Hull Restoration. Just a great utility mod for D mod play without changing the actual system at all.
- Neutrino Detector MK.II* - Adds a version of the Neutrino Detector with no false positives. Definitely a timesaver mod, I'm too stubborn to use it but it's definitely a nice quality of life improvement for folks who don't enjoy playing the "Fly horizontal for every pip to be sure it's real first" game.
- Scan those Gates - Lets you remotely scan gates to make life more convenient on story replays. Also can find shunts and sleepers, this is a bit cheaty but up to you if you use them. It's a singleplayer game after all!
- Logistics notifications* - gives you an estimate of how many days of supply you have left in the hauler so you can plan accordingly. (courtesy of /u/DogeDeezTheThird)
- Advanced Gunnery Control* - Helps if you're having difficulties with things such as Tachyon lances used as PD, Reapers as shield pressure, or Onslaughts refusing to vent. Gives a control panel for each weapon group for you to tweak to customize AI/Autofire behavior. (courtesy of /u/DogeDeezTheThird)
- Refit Filters* - If you have like 70 mods with weapons this should let you filter out the strike energy and the long ranged ballistics on those universal slots. (/u/DogeDeezTheThird)
- System Marker* - displays the time it takes for your disabled weapons and engines to be repaired. Also adds a circular indicator on your mouse icon to indicate when your ship system is ready. Sounds good if you're not like me and like panic flailing with no idea if you have a chance due to your own stupidity after burn diving your Onslaught into the middle of enemies. (Thanks to, you guessed it! /u/DogeDeezTheThird)
- Unthemed Weapon Utilities* - Shows weapon stats in the loadout AFTER your modifiers from skills and hullmods are applied. (/u/DogeDeezTheThird)
- QOL pack - Adds a bunch of smaller quality of life changes, I actually used to use this one and totally forgot to reinstall it! Great minor tweaks, but the real lifesaver is hyperspace transponder turning off automatically.

**'Minor' Feature Mods** (Mods that are fairly lightweight, touching only a few mechanical systems or just adding on something on top of it all)

- Fleet Size by DP - My bias on this one is strong, but to describe the mod simply, it removes the 'soft' 30 ship limit for fleets and instead makes it so you have 600 total deployment points to work with by default but you can change the numbers. If you don't like having to phase out your little wolfpack fleets, or want to carry more logi ships without feeling like you're missing out. This mod is very good and I highly suggest trying it for the dopamine hit of a true wolfpack run at least once.
- Unusually Gullible Hullmods - Adds more hullmods to the game... many of which are just... weird, rather than optimal, which can be fun! But some are pretty high on the power so YMMV. Can add some fun flavor to your fleet builds, just be mindful that especially with other mods, some of them can get pretty powerful. I enjoy this mod because it offers quirky ones rather than more meta ones, very taste dependent though, all of them are worth considering I'm sure.
- Supply Forging - Allows you to convert metal and heavy machinery into supplies based on your salvaging bonus. Nice to extend your long haul explorations some, while not solving the supply issue entirely. Lightweight, arguably fits up in QOL mods, and the upcoming Exploration Mods section.
- More Military Missions - Adds a handful of new types of missions to play with that are more, well, military focused. Defend a station, escort a convoy, good money makers and adds variety. Though it can be quite powerful to salvage the ships that come from this so self nerfing may be needed if it's not your vibe. Be mindful to select the option on setup that disables secret faction spawning, as otherwise you get some very whacky and gamebreaking (not always in a fun way with other mod interactions) results. Can play less nice with mods that add new ships and non-secret factions so YMMV.
- Ruthless Sector - Makes [Redacted] spawn in deep hyperspace sometimes, as well as various other tweaks to make the game more generally difficult. It's very customizable in settings, and a good mod to use if you feel some aspects of the game are a little too easy. Though be mindful of the consequences that can come of the [Redacted] Spawns if you keep it on.
- Starship Legends - Makes your vessels slowly gain a bit of 'personality' as they get more renowned in the form of some (usually) minor buffs/debuffs. Enemy vessels also get fleetwide buffs/debuffs from this same system. Also has a loyalty system, though I personally disabled it. It's a nice way to develop the story of your vessels and customize your fleet. As well as if you like the loyalty system, add rewards/punishments for how you treat your vessels.
- New Level of Confidence - Raises the level cap. Arguably a cheat mod, especially if you take the Xp boosts, but ultimately it's up to you to self regulate your experience anyways so, it can be a nice option for people who like to go extra lategame and have more flexibility in their skill builds.
- Progressive S mods - Gives each ship an independent XP tracker that lets you build in hull mods with at colonies. Though you can no longer do it with your own story points. Instead they can be used to increase a ship's story point limit, at the cost of making it more expensive to deploy. It's definitely a powerful mod, but it can make sticking with ships feel quite rewarding as you see them grow and improve.
- Ship Mastery System* - Like the above but possibly more (or less) powerful with some other features to skill changes and the overmap to boot, I'll admit I'm happy enough with the former that I've not given this one a deep look but this seems to be a solid mod worth a look.
- Exotica Technolgies* - Allows you to buff your ships in specialized ways. More armor or shields, fly faster but use more up fuel. Faster fighters for weaker armor. Bonuses apply to Enemies as well, and other features like installing alpha cores for more OP points. (Courtesy of /u/MtnMaiden)
- AI Tweaks* - Improves the combat AI and lets player-controlled Ai ships be less suicidal. Need I say more?(courtesy of /u/DogeDeezTheThird)
- Officer Extension* - Adds a variety of mild tweaks to officers, removing the cap of ones you can own, but still maintaining use limit. And has other minor features like letting you reset officers to level 1, suspend them for less pay, etc. (Thanks /u/Shrimpy223)
- Second in Command* - "The single best skill overhaul I've seen in years. The skill trees are diversified and moved into interchangable officers, with the exception of the Combat tree which becomes your PC's." (Recommended by multiple, testimonial by /u/Hipolipolopigus)
- Question of Loyalty - Sub module of "Ashes of the Domain" but all it's modules can be run on their own. I mention it further down but it was noted by /u/Hipolipolopigus this is worth a mention on it's own and I agree. It revamps the commission system to use the "major event" style tracker that you can build and lose progress in, and progress up the ranks in. It's very nifty and makes commissions feel a lot better (if also a fair bit stronger at high levels of progress)
- Objects Analysis 002* - "Provides a pseudo-active ability which lists points of interest in the current system in a tooltip, but does not provide a position or heading. Consider it a checklist for your current system. Goes great with Neutrino Detector Mk. 2." (Courtesy of /u/Hipolipolopigus)

**Ship Mods** (Mods that generally just add/alter ships and weapons and little more)

- Salvage Ship Expansion - Adds salvage ships of all sizes to the game rather than just the base one. This fills a niche of utility ship that previously was kind of hard to justify, especially if you didn't have fleet size by DP around. Also adds some salvage hullmods and two salvage themed industries that can be fun if you want to make fighting off colony threats your whole personality.
- Kazeron Navarchy - Gives the Persean League ships a bit of visual personality, similar to the Hegemony XIV ships. It's a slight buff to them but nothing too major. It's cute, if you like the color scheme and League, it's worth a consideration!
- Underworld* - Gives Pirates new Ships to play with. Technically adds a faction which has their own ships too, but to my understanding they don't have a base, it's more akin to a type of special tritach style of pirates. They look cool, I only briefly loaded it up to peek the ships but I've seen this mod consistently spoken highly of so if you want pirates to be more interesting this is a strong contender.
- High Tech Expansion - Adds a handful new high tech ships and weapons of varying styles. As with any expansion of this kind your main "consequence" to contend with is a bit of bloat in a certain type and having to contend to find specific things. The reward? A bunch of very cool looking ships that are pretty fun to use with varying levels of balance.
- NEON's Ship Pack* - Adds many good looking ships, but most notably adds unique ships like Old-Legion and XIV Invictus (Hello? Based department?)
- Arma Armatura* - Somewhat hard to place because it "Adds a minor faction, sick-ass Gundam mechs, and expands heavily on fighters. What's not to love? Also, it has a unique officer with actual voicelines whenever you go into battle.", but the main selling point here is mechs and fighters, possible waifu material. And as has also been noted, a very impressive story and subfaction with unique mechanics, with some mod integration to give other mods mechs too! (Thanks to multiple users for the notes!)
- Ship/Weapon Pack* - "It adds exactly what it says: Some ships and some weapons. All pretty in line with vanilla art style and power levels. This is one of those "I forgot that's from a mod" mods. It also adds a bunch of bounties with unique ships in them that can be salvaged after the battle." From what I can see this one is VERY popular for likely good reason, worth a peek! (Thanks /u/blofighter)
- Galactic Constellate* - Arguably also an exploration mod too, adds some unique bounties and ships to get from tracking them down, no clue on the balance but they definitely look cool! (Thanks /u/Nerezza_Floof_Seeker)
- Honorable Mentions* - I use a lot less ship focused mods as a personal preference so here's a list of some I've seen mentioned frequently that are likely worth a peek but I cannot personally vouch for enough to even give a semi-educated writeup on them. Sunrider, Tri-Tachyon Expansion, Pirate Mini Mod, others I'm sure!

**Faction Mods** (Mods that add New visitable/interactable Factions on the map, these almost always come with ships, and often some form of story as well, especially notable story/content mods will be noted. I WILL fail to mention your favorite one, I'm sorry, be gentle)

- Roider Union - A very biased personal favorite faction of semi-nomadic miners who have midline esque ships with a carrier/low tech armor flair. For the most part their ships are very balanced, the faction is very minimal and weak, but has a delightful impact on the flavor of the sector and helping it feel alive. So vanilla friendly in vibe that it was the only faction I kept on for my first .98 run.
- Tahlan Shipworks* - One of the most popular faction/ship mods, the fact I haven't personally played it yet is likely a grave sin to many. One thing is for certain, it's well beloved and spoken incredibly highly of by many for it's ship design. Worth noting that the "Legio" faction it adds is high power and designed to kick your butt though. Though they apparently can be turned off (Thanks /u/DogeDeezTheThird)
- Diable Avionics* - Now in Malware free flavor. A mod I only briefly opened up to look at their systems and ships and decide it wasn't exactly my personal vibe, but it's ships are sleek and despite the controversy, the mod itself is well beloved and enjoyed by many for it's sleek, fast ships. Worth a peek if you want more speedy midline style faction to spice up your sector, and I believe it has mechs too.
- Iron Shell* - Hegemony expansion mod that gives them angry Anime tax collectors (the XIV battlegroup) who will make sure you pay your dues to my understanding. Has some quests too, but I can't speak to those since I don't care who the IRS sends, I'm not paying my taxes.
- Luddic Expansion mod - Simple and sweet, gives the luddics a handful more ships to play with and an extra system to feel a little less tiny.
- Everybody Loves the Ko Combine - Adds Three (and a half) minor corporation factions that already existed in lore to control their relevant and thematic planets (at the cost of less independent/pirate planets by default). Has an optional mod that gives them a few more planets each two. Very lore friendly expansion, immaculate vibes, and they're all very Vanilla power level. I slept on this mod for too long and it's my second favorite faction mod behind Roiders now.
- Hazard Mining Incorporated - Adds a fairly large but surprisingly not too strong faction to the southwest area of the core that's vibe is "reckless fringe corporate traders". It has some notable exploration lore too but the meat of it is HMI itself, and it's ships which get better the more D mods they have, or are highly squishy glass cannons. Immaculate vibes, though the exploration content is a turnoff for some (and a big plus for others).
- Brighton Federation - Submod of HMI but can be used independently. Adds a tiny fringe polity, the "Brighton Federation" which is a tiny, struggling system that's ships are cobbled together [Redacted] hulls that run like shit and are generally very bad. They're adorable and very flavorful, I love them, protect them at all costs. Shield Shunted Radiant Reconstruction is the only ship they have that's actually kind of good and it's neat.
- HMI Supervillains - Another HMI faction submod. Adds Two groups of what are essentially deranged Genemodded pirates who hate eachother, one that larped too close to the sun as vampires, the other that went "lets just become actual fucking monsters and become cannibals". Despite their lofty insane goals, both factions are on the weaker side but add some flavorful bickering Emo kids on the block for you to saturation bombard while nobody minds because they're seen as literal monsters. Their ships are both unique mechanically but generally not that strong. They're neat flavor if you want more factions and want something a little more... Alien (even if it's derived from very foolish/insane humans)
- Mayasuran Navy - A delightfully styled mod that makes Mayasura it's own name on the map, fit with a ton of unique ships. The balance is definitely on the stronger side and you will see a LOT of their ships over the default ones, but that's not a bad thing if you want it. Plus it's very satisfying to turn a one planet minor faction into a power, and having a great soundtrack for the markets is a plus!
- Bultach Coalition. Irish space orks that hate Tri-Tach that make seriously cool lowtech lore friendly ships, being either very big or very unique. Their pristine Nanoforge is a little bit less lore friendly, but the faction is neat for those who do not mind. (Thanks to /u/IdiOtisTheOtisMain for reminding me about them!)
- The Star Federation* - Does still function despite the version being 2 behind. It adds a single system and is based of the game FTL. Generally considered a bit on the weaker side of ship mods [seemingly having poor PD and defenses], and brings some very unique weapons and playstyle when using them. (Courtesy of /u/GuildedCharr)
- United Auroran Federation (UAF)* - For all the sector pilots with anime profile pictures who sport radical ideologies, adds an entire faction in the bottom left of the map. They have a plethora of ships that vary in power levels, and some can be op. Has a story to it, has interactions with Nex and AOTD, possibly other mods. Generally a fun faction to play with for those who like more anime/powerful techy vibes. (Courtesy of /u/distrbed10000 and only mildly editorialized by me)
- No Such Org* - "Do you like phase ships? I like phase ships. A simple TriTach-adjacent faction attached to some great new phase ships." (unconfirmed to work in .98 though editing the data likely works. Thanks /u/Hipolipolopigus)
- Volkov Industrial Conglomerate* - "A very fun faction centered around gene tech and uses ships that are more reminiscent of aircraft than space ships. The ships are relatively balanced to vanilla, though I'd say in general they're on the stronger side. Especially their capitals, all of which can rightly be described as a Supership. They have catgirls and war crimes (bioweapons), and are vaguely criminal alligned, while also working under the Hegemony." (Testimonial from /u/Chaincat22)
- Honorable Mentions* - I know even less about these ones than the other ones I haven't played (there's so many faction mods after all!) but have heard their quality spoken to enough I at least want them to have a spotlight shone, Interstellar Imperium, Carter's Freetraders, Junk Yard Dogs, Adversary, Battlefleets of the Gothic Sector, Xhan Empire, Phillip Andrada Gas Station Manager and Diktat Enhancement, Meltson Industries, Sephora Conclave (not on Index), Your personal favorite faction

**Story Content/Exploration Mods** (A bit of a mixture of story content, or mods that just enhance what you find out in the sector. Many mods in other sections also have such content but these ones focus on it a bit more)

- The Knights of Ludd - An especially large story/content mod. Adds a small faction, the Knights of Ludd, tacked onto the Church, naturally. They have unique ships that are fun to use but fairly heavy on tradeoffs to balance them. But the real meat and potatoes of the mod is the horrors you can find and face through the quests and areas it adds. I haven't even seen it all myself, but I've seen enough to know this one is very high quality. And post .98... a lot more canon feeling than it used to be.
- Random Assortment of Things - An especially hard mod to categorize because it adds so much random stuff, but this category feels right. It adds a mini faction. An area in the abyss that *definitely* didn't inspire Alex at all for .98. A sort of colony but not type system for people to enjoy. And a bunch of little bits of exploration content of all kinds. It apparently even buffs actual colonies by allowing parallel construction (thanks /u/MtnMaiden)! Really his is a huge one, adds a lot, but it's hodgepodge of ideas can breathe a lot of life into playthroughs.
- What We Left Behind - It's old name gives a hint to it's original main focus. It used to be called "More Planetary Conditions." and while it does more than just that, that's the big meat of it. Adds a lot of stuff, it's lovely if you want your sector having more variety of planets with quirks to find and enjoy. it's well designed and does have content beyond that though too, but that's best discovered and enjoyed organically, it's quite well made!
- Unknown Skies - A big chunk of the variety to explore is just visually stunning backdrops and cool looking planet alternate types (which are just renamed versions of existing types so they don't break any interactions), but it does also have some unique planet conditions too. I truthfully don't know what's from WWLB and what's from this because they're both rather natural additions to my playstyle so I prefer to keep them on! This one is much more lightweight than the former though if you're cautious on content added.
- Kaleidoscope - Just adds new, pretty planet textures to existing planets. It's very nice, changes nothing but visuals, nothing more to say!
- Secrets of the Frontier.* Adds combat-layer capture objectives, an AI oriented "guardian" faction (They're tactially irrelevant in Nex, don't worry), and is possibly also about romancing a purple AI core named Sierra, jury is still out on this. (Suggested by multiple!)

**Colony Mods** (mods that's primary purpose can be attributed to how they interact with your/other colonies)

- Nexerelin - This classification is a mild understatement, but ultimately it affects the colony layer of the game the most, just... all of them. Nex turns Starsector into a strategy game, sort of. Your own gameplay loop can stay almost, or even entirely unchanged, but it adds a ton of systems for dynamic relations between you and the factions. Ways for the factions to fight eachother more and actively invade/take over the planets. Alliance systems, espionage. This is arguably the single, most popular mod in starsector besides QOL stuff. Many mods interact with it, some even rely upon it. Not everyone wants some 4x in their funny ship game, but if you do, Nex is for you. It's also hugely customizable, so a lot can be turned off as desired. It also adds a fun little questline and trade port in the middle of the sector that sells rare ships at a 2x markup, so that if you can't get them literally anywhere else due to hassle, you can overpay for some mild (but still limited) convenience. But more importantly it also lets you trade blueprints in to buy other blueprints that you don't have. There's too much to say on this one mod alone, but it's very much worth a serious look and consideration to see if it's your speed. Many people wont play without it for a reason.
- Ashes of The Domain - A mod that massively overhauls colonies, by adding a tech tree that goes well beyond vanilla options (and changes where some factions are on said tech tree), and if optional addons are chosen, colony events, exploration content, and even an overhaul to the commission system can be enjoyed! It also has some integration with other mods which is lovely. One big thing as well this eventually allows you to do is special projects, and things like making colony items, which can solve the "my sector didn't generate XYZ" issue if you were unlucky and don't use the Guarantee Rare Items mod.
- Industrial.Evolution - Arguably the gold Standard for many with regards to colony mods, adds a ton of features. There is a fair bit of exploration content, but the primary purpose is colonies, many more things you can build on your colonies, government types, and a pet system. What's not to love? (Or disable in it's highly customizable systems! Though be warned the mod creator is somewhat snarky in the descriptions which is a bit unnecessary)
- Grand Colonies* - Makes the space limit of buildings on planets a configurable soft cap, especially nice if playing with mods that add a fair amount more stuff to build.
- Terraforming and Station Construction - Lets you... well... terraform and construct stations. On it's own, it's a bit powerful since you can turn any old rock into a gemstone with just a bit of effort and being in a good system for it, though it is configurable. But it has one of the biggest integrations with Ashes of the Domain, by becoming it's own separate tech tree to explore which massively improves it's balance. The mod is great imo when combined, with a very nice reward for your efforts. It's also very funny in the endgame to build 3 astropolis stations around a planet and then give each one to a different faction that hates the other. (See Also Terraforming Made easy for a similar set of functionality on a possibly stronger iteration)
- Emergent Threats* - makes [Redacted] have some powerful hullmods, adds some ships, and a plethora of bounties. Really cool ships. Also has an optional IX revival submod as additional enemies if enabled. (Thanks /u/DogeDeezTheThird)

**Must Have Mods** (For mods that are so important they transcend opinion, I tried to be subjective even to other popular mods here, but if it's here, it's truly a must)

- Furry Portrait Pack - Kidding, in reality, there are no essential mods. Even ones people highly advocate, nothing is truly a must have, mix and match to find your style of play, that's the fun of it, everyone's modset will look different. There's a lot more mods out there I haven't listed, and a lot of them can get pretty crazy in what they add in a good way. Starsector as a community has modded literal Deltarune Bossfights in, so, the sky is the limit!

If you have any thoughts, or want to send a Planet Killer to my colony for not mentioning your favorite mod or not doing one listed enough justice, let me know! My hope is that this can be a thread that, at the very least I myself can point people to in the future when they ask questions about good mods to try. My experience is very Vanilla/Vanilla+ slanted in terms of preference, but stuff outside of it is valid, and not every mod I listed here, even ones I use, fit neatly into that mold. Thanks for giving my long, but very much not exhaustive list of mods to consider checking out a look!

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[–] MtnMaiden 79 points 10 months ago
Psssttt..in the RAT mod, it has parallel construction. No need to wait 90 days to build a new building. Build all you want if you got the money. Applies to enemies also
permalink embed save report reply

[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 28 points 10 months ago
You just broke my brain, that's such a nice QOL to have. I'm not changing it's category though, they're already vague and arbitrary as is!

Good to know though thanks! Glad it's parallel too, always prefer that to the player getting Asymmetrical buffs personally
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[–] MtnMaiden 12 points 10 months ago
Psstt...there's a mod called Just a Quarter, that quarters down build times, so 15 to 30 days instead of 90 / 120 days
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[–] DogeDeezTheThird Domain-Era Shitposter 34 points 10 months ago*
**Just some things to add:**

-Progressive S Mods, Ship Mastery, and Fleet Size by DP are not "minor additions", they are in fact **gameplay system overhauls** that change how the game is played and how your fleets are built. Progressive S Mods and Ship Mastery both completely change the **S-mod system**, and Fleet Size By DP changes how you balance out your fleets. It heavily encourages play with **smaller ships**, renders larger ships more detrimental to carry.

-Kaleidoscope is essentially a texture pack, it doesn't add new planets or conditions, just makes the existing ones look better.

-Tahlan's "Legio" faction is not balanced, and is by design. Its selling point is as a thorn in the side for YOU, specifically. Yes, dedicated to making the player's life miserable is its entire purpose. Its ships are high performance, but what's especially powerful about them is their campaign layer buffs to their colonies that makes them nigh irremovable in their home system unless you're in the endgame. Luckily you can turn them off if you don't like them.

-Neon's ship pack adds ships, but its selling point (IMO) is the unique ships like the Invictus XIV and the [OLD-LEGION].

**More mods I'd recommend:**

-Logistics notifications: gives you an estimate of how many days of supply you have left in the hauler so you can plan accordingly.

-AI Tweaks: Improves the combat AI and lets player-controlled Ai ships be less suicidal. Need I say more?

-Advanced Gunnery Control: Must have if you're having difficulties with Tachyon lances used as PD, Reapers as shield pressure, or Onslaughts refusing to vent. A control panel for each weapon group for you to tweak.

-Emergent Threats (Not with the IX revival), makes remnants have some powerful hullmods, adds some ships, and a plethora of bounties. Really cool ships.

-Secrets of the Frontier. Don't let the memes fool you, it isn't about romancing a purple Ai core, it adds combat-layer capture objectives, an AI oriented "guardian" faction (They're tactially irrelevant in Nex, don't worry), and Sierra, though you already know about her.

-Hyperdrive: Adds a special ability utilized by remnants (that you can steal from them) which lets you. essentially teleport up to 10 lightyears based on your direction and burn speed. Another time saver (and also a potent escape option against enemy fleets)

-System Marker: HUGE QoL that displays the time it takes for your disabled weapons and engines to be repaired. Oh, and it adds a circular indicator on your mouse icon to indicate when your ship system is ready (but the primary selling point is the former)

Hostile Intercept: Another QoL, shows you whether fleets on the campaign map are intercepting or searching for your fleet.

-Refit Filters: adds filters for the ship loadout screen weapons. If you have like 70 mods with weapons this should let you filter out the strike energy and the long ranged ballistics on those universal slots.

-Unthemed Weapon utilities: shows weapon stats in the loadout AFTER your modifiers from skills and hullmods are applied.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 4 points 10 months ago
The feedback is appreciated. I don't disagree they aren't truly 'minor' but the category is really more of a "this mod is fairly lightweight." alter in smaller ways or "minimalist additions" isn't meant to say they aren't able to have large impacts on your game. They definitely still do, they just are touching a lot less of the game at large to do so than any of the larger feature mods that I rolled into other fitting categories.

I did in fact note Kaleidoscope was just textures! But it's still "enhancing what you find out in the sector" by giving you more to look at imo!

Thanks for the note on Tahlan and Neon's especially, I'm very uninformed on them, I'll adjust their descriptions to reflect that feedback!

I'll also toss on those mod recommendations, except Speedup, as that is the very first one mentioned for a reason!
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[–] DogeDeezTheThird Domain-Era Shitposter 8 points 10 months ago*
> -possibly also about romancing a purple AI core named Sierra, jury is still out on this.

SOTF is not beating the allegations it seems.

Maybe I'll elaborate:

Sierra has the highest number of interactions (and the only fleet-centric contact) in the mod, she's got her quirks, and is commonly joked about being the "AI daughter" of John Starsector

Her high rel interaction (75/100) Has allegedly romantic confrontations even after the edit, as opposed to just romantic connotations before the edit. (its up to interpretation, depends on whether "Watch I don't wind myself around your soul" is considered a sexual innuendo or an assassination threat)

But there is no evidence that suggests she is to be a romance option! I assure you, there is absolutely not a quest ending in you going to her ship and getting freaky with exactly 12 of her spider drones while in phase space that grants you the Soulrend hullmod which doubles Energy weapon damage by 30% on Sierra's ships after using the Concord Shift!

(Also I added some more on my previous post(
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 6 points 10 months ago
...All I know is it seems funniest to leave the allegations up and that fans of the mod will likely have a good sense of humor about it... and likely future fans may be drawn by that xD

Though personally I wouldn't read that sentence as either sexual innuendo or threat. Just sounds affectionate and bonding to me lol
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[–] Multiheaded 1 point 10 months ago*
IX Revival from ET is fine, they're just essentially another Legio-style boss faction to beat. High power, but goes fine especially with other faction mods. Some really banging gear.
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[–] DogeDeezTheThird Domain-Era Shitposter 1 point 10 months ago
Yeah, The real annoyance in IX is the Trinity Worlds, basically just normal Emergent Threat ships but green, they are just a pain in the campaign layer and don't add meaningful content. If you disable the Trinity Worlds in ET: IX its pretty managable.
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[–] vicegrip_ 1 point 10 months ago
Trinity worlds: we have Threat drones at home.
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] GuildedCharr 18 points 10 months ago
Obligatory The Star Federation mod mention, particularly because it does still function. Has to be my favourite faction mod for the game, so much so that I have to disable it or else I will use the ships exclusively on every run.

It adds a single system and is based of the game FTL. Generally considered a bit on the weaker side of ship mods I believe, and brings some very unique weapons and playstyle when using them.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 5 points 10 months ago
Oh that sounds delightfully charming, I'll add it to the list since you've provided the rundown pretty well already... and might have to add it myself.
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[–] OpposingFarce 15 points 10 months ago
Absolutely excellent post. Saving for later. Just finished my very first vanilla playthrough. Not sure I'm in the mood for Nex yet, but we'll see. Sounds like a lot.

I did dabble with some faction mods today on a quick mod test. Xhan Empire seems very well done.

Also faction mods make trading so much more interesting
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 5 points 10 months ago
Happy to hear it! That's exactly what I'm hoping people are able to use this for, a reference to toy with and take ideas for when they explore.

I will say I don't find Nex to be as overwhelming as it sounds/looks. Really you don't have to do much if anything at all with it if you don't want to, it just adds new options. But, it's Very much not for everyone and the game can be massively enhanced even with just trying a couple faction mods first!
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[–] unending_shorelines 4 points 10 months ago
Yeah, Nexerelin can be overwhelming at times, especially with all the wars and invasions going around, but there are a ton of settings to suit your needs if you have Lunalib. One of the toggles I always use on Nex is the one where factions can't invade each other until I establish my first colony, which means the Heggies can't just eat up the core worlds in the blink of an eye while I'm busy exploring.
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[–] Drewgamer89 2 points 10 months ago
I need to remember this setting next time I play. I always love the exploration phase of the game as much as the empire management-ish phase, but that looming threat of factions cannibalizing each other is a bit of a nag.
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[–] Chaincat22 7 points 10 months ago
Volkov Industrial Conglomerate, or VIC, is a very fun faction centered around gene tech and uses ships that are more reminiscent of aircraft than space ships. The ships are relatively balanced to vanilla, though I'd say in general they're on the stronger side. Especially their capitals, all of which can rightly be described as a Supership. They have catgirls and war crimes (bioweapons), and are vaguely criminal alligned, while also working under the Hegemony. If you run nex, they'll almost always from an alliance with the Hegemony unless you have Ironshell (which starts Heg in an alliance)
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[–] Drewgamer89 1 point 10 months ago
VIC is the one with a capital that has a large dual-shot energy spinal cannon right? That thing is a blast.
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[–] Chaincat22 2 points 10 months ago
The new one might be that, I never played with it. The Apollyon is the star of the show, the capital with a hyperdrive. Oriax is the other one which sucks flux out of nearby ships and tesla coils nearby enemies, playing a more defensive role.
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[–] Drewgamer89 1 point 10 months ago
So I finally got around to re-installing Starsector (and mods) and I my old brain may have been mixing several things together.

That said the Apollyon was definitely one of those things. It's got that cool "dash-drive" thingy that leaves behind a fairly devastating energy wake. So much fun and mayhem-inducing lol.

The spinal weapon I thought went along with it...I still have no idea where it came from (or if it was even from Starsector LOL).
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[–] Chaincat22 2 points 10 months ago
It does have a spinal weapon tbf, but it's an arcing missile barrage lol. The Stolas also has a single shot shotgun spinal.
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[–] Vilekyrie More Autocannon 7 points 10 months ago
Arma actually adds more than just the Arma Armatura faction and gundams (though that is admittedly the good chunk of it). It also includes a unique story line with several missions as well as a unique mission modifier which forces you to utilize only frigates and destroyers (the mission actually takes place in a planet's atmosphere, the transition is pretty insane to see). It also includes the MRC faction, The Meshan Reprisal Coalition is a pirate subfaction (though they aren't outright hostile to you at the start like pirates) that has no base of it's own, they spawn from pirate bases and interact heavily with Nex because the faction specifically targets the largest and most aggressive faction (i.e. the faction that has attempted/successfully taken over the most planets within the previous in game year) and act as a sort of Robin Hood-esque force, depending on how large your own faction is, or who you are commissioned by they can easily be your friend or foe.

Another point of note is, that a lot of other mods have mechs baked into them, but they'll only appear in game if you've got Arma installed, such as Sindrian Fuel Company or Diable Avionics (though I believe the Diable Mechs may be a seperate submod now).
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 2 points 10 months ago
Good to know, neat intel! Kept the placement but expanded it's description a bit to indicate this info, I reckon people inclined to take interest in such a mod will have the jumping off point now to explore it!

As for me... hearing about that robin hood balancing mechanic for nex is mighty tempting. Might have to forego my own personal sensibilities for that one lol
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[–] blofighter Ad astra. 6 points 10 months ago
I don't see Ship/Weapon Pack anywhere, so I'm adding it to the list. It adds exactly what it says: Some ships and some weapons. All pretty in line with vanilla art style and power levels. This is one of those "I forgot that's from a mod" mods. It also adds a bunch of bounties with unique ships in them that can be salvaged after the battle.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 1 point 10 months ago
A massive oversight on my part, I think the generic name threw me lol! Looks great I reckon I'm trying this on my own next run since the only ship that looks a bit much/gives me pause is the Hubship, but if it's roughly the level of HMI's Locomotive class it's probably fine for even my own tastes! (Until that thing gets speed boosts from other mods... holy crap do I have a cursed clip of that lol.)

Definitely something people look to enjoy with how popular/many responses the mod has
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[–] Kang_Xu 6 points 10 months ago
I feel like this should be stickied.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 1 point 10 months ago
It definitely could help! But with luck people can just share the link to folks if nothing else

I also deliberately included the actual question people ask in the title so it's more searchable
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[–] MtnMaiden 5 points 10 months ago
Exotica Technolgies.

Allows you to buff your ships in specialized ways.

More armor or shields. Faster but use more fuel. Faster fighters or weaker armor.

Includes special abilities, like firing 100% Faster but reduced firing for a bit. Guardian shield. Missile fabricator.

Or the rare, dunno if it exists anymore, nanotechnology armor. Allows for armor hp regen.

Also Allows your ship to field more OP points by installing an alpha core.

Yes you can mod every module of a multi module ship.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 3 points 10 months ago
Nifty! I'll condense this and toss it up, definitely could be something people might want to try for their runs!
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[–] MtnMaiden 3 points 10 months ago
Prepare to be stuck in the ship fitting screen even longer as you mod each ship / each module.

The buffs are strong too, like 50% more hull at cost of armor durability. So it's nothing to sneeze at. I always mod every single one of my keeper ships
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 3 points 10 months ago
Probably not my own type of mod as an autofit andy on a lot of my runs where I'm feeling more lazy, but definitely one I'll have to keep an eye on myself if/when I do a more "Powerful Sector" run
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[–] unending_shorelines 5 points 10 months ago*
Arma Armatura.

One of the two mods I've been waiting for to update (the other one is Lost_Sector, which adds a fairly strong sub-faction of [REDACTED], experimental weapons and ships, and more exploration content) before I start my .98 playthrough properly. Adds a minor faction, sick-ass Gundam mechs, and expands heavily on fighters. What's not to love? Also, it has a unique officer with actual voicelines whenever you go into battle.

Dawn, my beloved...
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 2 points 10 months ago
Tossed Arma up! This whole post was inspired by the guy who made a tier list placing this exact mod in a special tier of it's own above everything else. I thought that was maybe not the best way to sell people on your favorite mod because people immediately start comparing it to THEIR favorite rather than seeing how they can work together though, so I made this!

It does look, admittedly, sick as hell. Though I'm definitely saving it for when I do the "fuck it, everything OP and immersion breaking" future run lol
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[–] wizteddy13 2 points 10 months ago
RIGHT yes seconding the Arma Armatura mention, absolutely fantastic faction with cool mechs and fighters and just a super sleek aesthetic. Also WINGCOM for carriers is genuinely game-changing.

Speaking of Dawn, how far [redacted]
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] unending_shorelines 1 point 10 months ago
...Dawn has a [redacted]

AHHHHHHHHH
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] wizteddy13 1 point 10 months ago
Lmaooo oh man [redacted]
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] unending_shorelines 1 point 10 months ago
Oh yeah, I've encountered those. [redacted]
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] wizteddy13 1 point 10 months ago
Yeah I got those. Still, fun stuff.
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[–] Shrimpy223 5 points 10 months ago
I want to suggest Officer Extension a handy QoL mod that makes officers much easier to manage. Removes the limit to how many officers you can manage, although you're still limited to how many you can assign (kinda cheaty I guess, but I've always hated how 'rigid' the vanilla game is with that). Lets you suspend officers, demote them, add tags to them and apply filters when selecting them. All in all just really handy and the kind of thing that should be in vanilla.
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[–] MtnMaiden 4 points 10 months ago
Terraforming Made Easy.

A simple terraforming mod that requires no items to find, uses cash, lots of cash.

Has buildings that change different conditions, you can remove anything, but adding conditions require pre requisites.

Like plentiful violatiles requires a cold planet, so you have to make it cold first.

There are special status you can attain if you build certain conditions.

Paradise planet gives you bonus to light industry, farming and 50% income boost.

Fortress world: gives stability boost and a multiplier on fleet size.

Forge world: all industries produce 1 extra output, and allows you to build 1 extra industry.

Doom world: Krieg
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[–] buttholeglory 5 points 10 months ago
I will fight an army of Heg Goons for Sierra.
permalink embed save report reply

[–] RoakeNN 3 points 10 months ago
This post is golden
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 4 points 10 months ago
Much love, I worked hard on it (though not as hard as even a single modder lol), cheers!
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[–] distrbed10000 11 points 10 months ago
United Auroran Federation (UAF) - i get some people hate it cause oh no anime, but it adds an entire faction in the bottom left of the map. They have a plethora of ships that vary in power levels, and some can be op. Has a story to it, has interactions with nex and AOTD, and maybe a couple other mods. Generally a fun faction to play with imho but of course everyone may or may not like it.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 5 points 10 months ago
Oh yeah! That's another name I've heard a fair bit too, I completely forgot, will definitely throw it in honorable mentions at least for now! If you or somebody else wanna take a crack at a more elevator pitch description I'd tack it up for ya. Better to just explain it's general vibe and pros/cons without the "some people hate it" explanation I think, so that if someone may be interested they can see the description and see if that sounds like something they might like for their game! Just cause it ain't my tastes doesn't mean it isn't a lot of other people's!
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[–] duncandun 8 points 10 months ago
Uaf is wildly op compared to most factions lol
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] Spartan448 7 points 10 months ago
It's stronger than it should be in Nex because of *very* generous fleet point values, but in combat they fold like wet tissue paper. Sure, infinitely linfinite missiles *can* be OP in extended fights, and Typhan strike runs are extremely problematic. But none of that matters when lowtech shields layered over mediocre armor and hull means you can alpha strike their some of their biggest ships with an Eagle or a couple Sunders. They're also generally very slow, have way too much inertia, and don't have anywhere close to enough flux cap or venting to feed their flux-hungry weapons.

The kit's decent though if you've got the flux for it, so the best thing is usually just to salvage their gear and use it on something actually good. Notable exception to the rule for combat ships would be the Exoria, which is a genuinely capable little 20 DP carrier.
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[–] wizteddy13 1 point 10 months ago
It really, truly isn't, at least not it's current iteration. The main aspect that gave the faction the OP moniker are the Semibreves - people like to call it OP because of its standout aesthetic and anime looks.

If you sat down and did a breakdown, you'd see that their ships are actually terribly flux-hungry for their weapons and cannot sustain a fight to save their life. Their fighters are good, but everything else? Comparable, if not fairly worse than most other modded factions.
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[–] Nalkor 4 points 10 months ago
The only time current UAF comes off as truly monstrous to fight against is if you play a Pirate run with lots of D-Mods and somehow neglecting your Point Defense stuff. Most turrets have some really huge coverage, or a full 360-degrees on stuff meant for PD on a frigate. Most of their Destroyers are logistics ships, only a couple of their cruisers can be counted as combat viable. Indeed, a good chunk of the UAF's power is tucked away behind their Capitals, Supercapitals, and Mini/Semibreves and you don't want the AI to be firing off the latter or you'll be losing a lot of your own ships. Their Onslaught-version (UAFslaught is my nickname) has no shield, kind-of-weaker armor, and a whopping 30% CR per deployment, with a 3% CR restored per day. The utter lack of beam weapons hurts their performance against phase ships too.

Plus I swear the AI in 0.98 has not been kind to Carrier-centric fleets, player or AI-controlled fleets.
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[–] wizteddy13 3 points 10 months ago
Lots of good points, thank you for articulating this better than I could have.
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[–] duncandun 6 points 10 months ago
Calling the fighters with minibreves simply 'good' is a wild understatement lol
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[–] wizteddy13 1 point 10 months ago
I did say breves were OP, and fighters with breves would thus naturally be more than 'good'. That's just the Taufan wings though, with a fairly limiting 32OP cost, and you can just not use them.
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[–] unending_shorelines 0 points 10 months ago
Surely the solution to this is to add more OP factions? *Looks at Legio and Hivers*
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 1 point 10 months ago
from my understanding this is in fact some folks approach to things! Power to yall and your funni anime ships
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 2 points 10 months ago
I went ahead and just tweaked your wording a bit and tossed it up, let the people have their anime, I say!
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] IdiOtisTheOtisMain MISGOT 2 points 10 months ago
If you're gonna tack on the UAF then why not Iron Shell too? Animesector frfr

Heck, why isn't SOTF here? It's awesome.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 3 points 10 months ago
I am woefully underexperienced with the Animesector side of things personally due to my preference on ship/faction balance typically. But they're certainly welcome here if people give me a snippet for it I can stick up there!
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[–] distrbed10000 1 point 10 months ago
Op already mentioned iron shell, I forgot about sotf (dont have ss installed on my laptop because with the amount of mods I run, it would probably melt)
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] OldPayphone UAF best mod 2 points 10 months ago
UAF faction mod is easily the best mod, right next to Nexerelin.
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[–] wizteddy13 3 points 10 months ago
High effort post. A lot of good mentions, I'll have to go back home later today and check with my own modlist to see if anything significant got missed, but for now it doesn't seem so.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 2 points 10 months ago
I did my best! It helps when the thing you're putting effort into is also your excuse to procrastinate on other things lol
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] Chaincat22 3 points 10 months ago
For a rule of thumb, Leading Pip is less reliable the smaller the ship is. Trying to use leading pip to hit a Kite or a Hound is kinda a fools errand since they can just manuever out of the way every time. You want saturation fire, not precision, for those kinds of ships. Unless you're using a beam or lance.
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[–] Nerezza_Floof_Seeker 3 points 10 months ago*
Didnt see anyone mention it, but Galactic Constellate is a pretty good minimod, its a CN mod that adds a bunch of bounties for very cool and unique looking ships.

Edit: also worth mentioning:

- second in command, which overhauls skills and adds a system of XOs that allow you to pretty much freely swap alot of fleet buff skills around, with XOs specializing around different fields doing different stuff (like theres one for automation wjich gives ai ship points, one for smallcraft which buffs smaller ships, etc). Personal combat skills are separate and still under the normal vanilla system.
- tahlan additions: unofficial addon mod to tahlan that adds stuff to tahlan, most notably letting you recruit louisa through a questline, and adds a sierra-like ai that you can talk to and who can pilot ships through a hullmod. Some might not want to add this though as its not an officially sanctioned addon and nia (tahlans author) doesnt like it afaik.

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[–] Agung442 2 points 10 months ago
And just as i was finished modding my game and running a playthrough this guide came out 😡
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[–] Minimum_System7018 2 points 10 months ago
Absolutely goated, first post I've ever saved, big thanks for the effort
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 2 points 10 months ago
Cheers! Glad it's worth tucking away, hope it helps!
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[–] OpposingFarce 2 points 10 months ago
For anyone using the Salvage Ship Expansion, is using one of the larger ships actually more efficient than using two vanilla salvage rigs? Can't find any information on its forum thread
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 1 point 10 months ago
Compared to Vanilla it's more than one slightly less than two by default, but it also adds extra salvage related hullmods you can get on, which can allow you to easily get each one to 60% (diminishing) boosts. Said hullmods can also be put on other ships, so I like to put them on my Logi ships to increase my salvage percentages into the ~100-150% range by endgame
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[–] Spartan448 2 points 10 months ago
If you're going to mention Mayasuran Navy, you should add a warning about using it with Nex. They're in an alliance with the Persean League by default... but they're not a permanent member, so they can be ripped out of it. And even if they aren't, the League does a horrible job defending it. So it'll usually die to the very first invasion to target it, because it doesn't have enough defense fleets on its own and the one really powerful one that's baked into the mod is *usually* too busy fighting Lost Astropolis or flying into the sun to actually fucking defend the planet. And even then it's not uncommon for the fleet to simply be overwhelmed by even moderate size invasion forces. Mayasura generally doesn't survive the first 10 cycles if not actively protected.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 3 points 10 months ago
Honestly this is why I turn on faction respawn. I like to run smaller weaker factions that can get rolled but I like em having a chance to come back
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[–] Drewgamer89 2 points 10 months ago
Does faction respawn mean that it's not possible to ever fully "paint the map" should someone decide to go the nuclear option on the rest of the sector? (IE will factions ALWAYS come back or is there a way to prevent it).

On the one hand I hate that a market can just get poofed before I get to interact with it much. On the other hand, if I'm doing the poofing if usually like it to stay poofed 🥵
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 2 points 10 months ago
Yes and no? Realistically I see the respawn attempts fail like 80% of the time. It doesnt just give them stuff back for free, they basically every so often get a vengeance fleet to attempt to reinvade the homeland. Said fleet still has to win and can very much be stopped / prevented.

For some, this can be annoying, for me it's more content to engage with, plus if you REALLY want a faction to "stay gone" you can give them a shitty size 3 world on the fringes as exile so they can't respawn
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[–] Rokeugon 2 points 10 months ago*
good comprehensive list and explanation. frankly i don't agree with a fair few of them. but i always appreciate others providing their modlist. it only benefits to widen possibilities. only thing im hard against is "diable avionics".

dont get me wrong.. i like the ships and faction as a whole but it overly underperforms especially against vanilla ships. the whole shtick with their built in weapon modules is missile dominance but its only meant to overwhelming. the missiles themselves dont really do good damage. doesn't have sufficient HP to survive overwhelming enemy line defences. Alot of people like to play much older version of DA because it was genuinely a faction mod to be feared at the time

its nice that someone took over to preserve the faction but its been too adjusted over the many years to be balanced with vanilla while not really maintaining the balance all too well. they fit into a niche right now whether youre playing .97 or .98, and its mostly mid range engagements missile & fighter spam.

youl be more than likely supplementing majority of the missile mounts for DA ships with vanilla dragonfire / DEM missiles etc. as it has the power, HP and range for the types of engagements you get into.

Also very surprised you haven't mentioned "RAT" in the list. such a nice addition for any new modded playthroughs especially if its someone new to modding
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 3 points 10 months ago
Funnily enough I came to the opposite conclusion myself when I briefly checked out the mod, but this was more because I didn't like how much stuff their colonies were given in regards to the faction map I was cultivating. Pristine Nanoforges, a lot of AI cores, and they even had a Synchotron core colony. I didn't play much around with their ships though, it was mostly eyeballing some of their big ones (the speed definitely stood out to me).

That said! This isn't my exact personal modlist, even of ones I've played I don't run them all at once. And some have been omitted due to not really being necessary mentions (like Animated Colony items just being kinda nice to look at but really not seeming to fit, or flag packs). Though, I will admit I run a lot of them at once. A lot of these, like Diable are asterisked because I haven't meaningfully played them. It's more of a way to let people know about them and know if it's their vibe. It's good to have comments like this so people can decide if the balance of their ships makes them more or less interested though! Your comment actually makes me more interested in trying it, for example! I may swallow my faction map/rare item balance pickiness to give it a go if their ships really are that comfortably within the power level I prefer to include!

I would be curious what ones you don't agree with, feedback is valued, if I described a mod poorly or gave a bad pitch that you think would dissuade someone from wanting to try it, (or just plain misrepresented it) I'd like to try to give it a better shake! I was a bit jokey on a few admittedly lol

Also RAT is on the list, it's in the Story/Content section, but I note it's kind of a hard one to categorize. Banger mod, well worth considering for folks I feel
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[–] Rokeugon 1 point 10 months ago
IMHO that sounds like other mods related to it because yeah their main world "Sivie" i think its called has a pristine nano forge but i played strictly with just the faction mod and all the utility graphics libraries. i did not encounter any of what you described. and my playthrough started a week before .98 dropped and lasted till the first revision patch came for .98

its just my personal experience that their ships were are dominating in alot of aspects. they very much can get overwhelmed by phased high tech ships. alot of their ships more often than not dont have the best flux control... its more niche aspect without really having any of the flavour that makes it special in that niche if that makes sense!

also apologies for not spotting RAT

and the mods i dont agree with are.

- "Unusually Gullible Hullmods"
- "Supply Forging
- "D-Mod Services"

2 i think are pointless and 1 i think makes the game just far too easy. i personally believe the game should drill in adequate preparing for journeys especially with bigger fleets which supply forging just completely bypassed that need mid to late game. which chances are you should have a colony by that time. its just my personal preference tho
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 1 point 10 months ago
I just downloaded Diable Raw from the mod index, but perhaps I clicked a link with addons when downloading it without realizing that gave it those other powerful colonies, may be something for me to look at again. Honestly the pristine nanoforge bothers me a bit, but I'd say the random Synchotron fuel colony was more bothersome to me because these things can tip the fuel economy of the game to the point that it feels too easy to top up due to supply.

I much prefer ships on the weaker side when added, especially because I find great personal usage out of Derelict run fleets, so I take a special charm out of massing "less good" ships to acheive a goal. Hearing they have clear weaknesses that you see them struggle with makes me more interested personally. As such D-Mod Services is very, very useful to me. Ultimately I think it's utterly useless or a lifechanger for someone in terms of convenience, and it entirely comes down to playstyle of how one constructs fleets.

Especially if you're doing D-Mod fleets where you need your D-Modded ships to have specific roles to fill. For example, Comprimised Hull/Armor on your Derelict Promethius MK II can relegate it to a full reset to fish for the right mods again by destroying it's already middling survivability. Or Malfunctioning Comms on your Condors. That mod can be a massive timesaver for that. Doubly so if you just want general D-Mods and don't mind as much what you get and don't pay the cost.

If you're someone who leans Hull Restoration, or just rips whatever you can find that's already damaged, it's a mod with no value for you, but that doesn't really make it pointless, just different.

As for Unusually Gullible. It's certainly not pointless but it's very much not essential. I wanted to list at least one hullmod mod, and personally, the one I use is that one because it has some fairly fun ones to discover and make your ships do different niche things. They have exactly as much point as you want them to, and that comes down to you to use them or not. I list it to let people know it exists as something interesting not to say you SHOULD use it! Hell even though I keep it on, there's been plenty of campaigns I didn't use a single one, so it just varies, really.

As for supply forging, an entirely valid perspective for certain. Truth be told I very rarely use it myself, and when I do, it's always been by the time I already have my logistics solved and am just doing long haul explorations where I'm so full up on metal I would prefer to make it something slightly more worthwhile rather than just dumping it. It's rarely 'saved' me from overextending, but it's been a thing I've at times gone "hey that was nifty to have".

Ultimately if someone ran *all* of these mods at once, their game would be rather bloated. I don't run all of the mods listed without asterisks at once, it simply means I've played around with it enough to comment on it with firsthand experience. I run a lot of them, and my most recent run *is* my most modded yet, but even still, people should pick and choose! None of my comments are to say you should use or like these mods, just that I don't think they're pointless, or, in the case of Supply Forging, just sharing my experience with it not having too much of an impact but being a nice enough little thing sometimes. Though I will say in all fairness as a Derelict Ops enjoyer, supply issues are much less often a concern for me to begin with due to the low fleet maintenence cost so that may well be why.
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] noso2143 2 points 10 months ago
Solid list

Got some of my own suggestions

Qol

Console commands: like with any game thst has console commands it can end feeling very cheaty if you let yourself go overboard but I find it useful for when something breaks or for testing things.

Factions

Interstellar imperium: my favourite faction mod in starsector. It adds space rome I can't say if it's op or not as I'm not good enough at the game to know but I love the ship designs, their planets are all governed by alpha ai cores they worship as gods and the heg don't like them which in next means the heg is slowed slightly in its eating of the core worlds
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[–] RiseInfinite 2 points 8 months ago
A very nice and comprehensive list.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 1 point 8 months ago
Glad ya like it! I'm definitely hoping it remains relevant for folks at least for the duration of .98, keeping my eye out for any new notable additions as they come as well!
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[–] Coffee_SF 2 points 8 months ago
you're a god
permalink embed save report reply

[–] IdiOtisTheOtisMain MISGOT 4 points 10 months ago
Bultach Coalition. Irish space orks that hate Tri-Tach that make seriously cool lowtech friendly ships, being either very big or very unique. Must-have imo, but they may or may not be compatible with .98 yet.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 2 points 10 months ago
Oh yeah! I'd forgotten I tried them, I unfortunately didn't end up playing with them because I found it a bit disappointing that the dakka faction had a Pristine Nanoforge for some reason, but, it's still worth a mention, that's just my own personal balance preference!
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[–] MtnMaiden 4 points 10 months ago
Sephora Conclave with DME refit:

Adds a new faction of high tech anime people. More ships, more weapons. Ability to remove S Mods.

But the most important thing is the ability to S Mod your ship with 3 powerful mods.

One boosts your attacks, like shoot further, better tracking.

One boosts your defense, like...60% reduction in shield costs.

And the last one...is like safety over rides without the OP cost.

Oh and more S mods.

Beams cause hard flux. Improve rare loot drop rates. Missile fabricator.
permalink embed save report reply

[–] wizteddy13 3 points 10 months ago
Sephira Conclave with DME is great, but the issue of course is that it's kinda homebrew, so you're going to have to dig a bit to find it.
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[–] Justhe3guy Antimatter blaster supremacy 2 points 10 months ago*
Yeah since DME was taken down by the author Sephira got screwed since it was based on DME...well now you google Sephira Conclave to get both downloads
permalink embed save parent report reply

[–] Nalkor 2 points 10 months ago
So about Tahlan Shipworks, it's best paired with the Bootleg mod, Tahlan Additions found on the Corvus Freeport discord server.
https://cdn.discordapp.com/attachments/970013117276893245/1362742679309647882/image.png?ex=68077505&is=68062385&hm=311835b22a3cc4c45170e6df930d4c741f6ac20679f7ae35c2da0fcbf24e6cdc&

Nia's "Fuck You" code that made all non-Tahlan Shipworks GH hull have -90% PPT disabled.

That's just one thing fixed by Tahlan Additions, can you imagine using a Hullmod and because it wasn't on the exact right kind of ship as dictated by the mod author, it now decreases Peak Performance Time by a whopping 90%? Holy shit that's dumb.
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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 2 points 10 months ago
Oh that sounds not great! I'll probably refrain from actively listing mod addons not from the mod creator just for consistency sake but this sounds like a valuable consideration for folks for sure, good you mentioned it and why!
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[–] DeadRights 1 point 9 months ago
As an update to this, I went looking into the problem further and found this on the Tahlan Shipworks GitHub Changelog (Line #90).

> 1.2.6
>
> - Fixed heavily reduced PPT on D-modded GH hulls

Given that it is currently on Version 1.4.1, and the patch notes for 1.2.6 were added in August, 2023 (almost two years ago), I'm not sure what's going on here.
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[–] Nalkor 1 point 9 months ago
Given that the code referenced made no mention of D-Mods, it's likely Nia was fine with pristine GH hulls still having -90% PPT. Even the comment on the obscure/obfuscated code was all 'lmao' which shows intention.
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[–] Hipolipolopigus Likes the Odyssey a little too much 2 points 10 months ago

**QOL Mods**

- **QoL Pack** has a bunch of features listed, but the main one for me is `Transponder Off in Hyperspace` (Formerly separate as Transpoffder).

**'Minor' Feature Mods**

- **Second-in-Command** is the single best skill overhaul I've seen in years. The skill trees are diversified and moved into interchangable officers, with the exception of the Combat tree which becomes your PC's.
- **Objects Analysis 002** provides a pseudo-active ability which lists points of interest in the current system in a tooltip, but does not provide a position or heading. Consider it a checklist for your current system. Goes great with Neutrino Detector Mk. 2.
- While Ashes of the Domain as a whole has been listed, the **Question Of Loyalty** submodule is worth mentioning on its own. A complete overhaul of the commission system that makes it more engaging instead of just regular small amounts of free money. Doesn't require the rest of AotD.

**Faction Mods**

- **No Such Org**. Do you like phase ships? I like phase ships. A simple TriTach-adjacent faction attached to some great new phase ships. Seems to work fine in modern game versions with some metadata editing since it doesn't do anything particularly fancy, although I haven't yet tested it in 0.98a specifically.

**Must Have Mods**

- **ThirstSector** portraits. As much as I *thoroughly loathe* generative "AI", this is a fine use case. Simple redraws of vanilla portraits, with some support for mods to make quality and style more consistent. Mod replacements need to be manually installed in their respective mod folder since Starsector doesn't have proper load order management. Yes, there is an NSFW version with way more boobs.

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[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 3 points 10 months ago*
Oh this is fantastic, wonderfully formatted too with the links, I'm too dead tired to copy this over tonight, but I'll try to remember to do so in the morning, thanks for the contribution!

Edit: I will note I'm going to refrain from noting Thirstsector. While I'm shameless about the portrait packs I use for fun, this feels like the kind of thing that anyone can easily just peek and choose their style on. I suppose an argument could be made Kaleidoscope shouldn't be on due to pure textures either then but I'm biased. I also admittedly don't want this to be a staging ground for the AI art debate. But comments like this are prefectly valid places to mention them!
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[–] steve123410 1 point 10 months ago
Huh, the star federation mod always crashes my game when I try to load it in so I considered it a write off (I think the missile microforge modification they added does it). I dunno how you made it work
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[–] wizteddy13 1 point 10 months ago
Odd, I have to do nothing more than just update the version with the notepad. Maybe it conflicts in some way with one of your other mods? Granted, I haven't tested it for 0.98 yet
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[–] robins_writing 1 point 10 months ago
God I love Diable Avionics's look and the wanzers, but for the life of my I cannot build effective Diable ships
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[–] sakenyi 1 point 10 months ago
I'll throw in a little faction mod that (according to me) just has the best faction music and fits in quite well with the vanilla aesthetic;

Metelson Industries
permalink embed save report reply

[+] [deleted] 10 months ago (1 child)

[–] Traditional_Boot9840 2 points 3 months ago
great post mate!
permalink embed save report reply

[–] Mokare_RUS 1 point 10 months ago
FYI, Corvus pirtates recently updated the legendary mod of all times - Meme Portraits!
permalink embed save report reply

[–] Tutorele Ludd's Favorite Heretic [S] 3 points 10 months ago
And thus, the sector was granted brainrot once again, praise be
permalink embed save parent report reply

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